

Αἴλιος Διονύσιος ὁ Ἀλικαρνασσεύς

Aelius Dionysius of Halicarnassus on Attic Names

eul_aid: psw

Period: Ῥωμαϊκή [Roman](#)
Dialect: Ἀττικίζουσα τεχνική [Atticizing Technical](#)
Domain: Γραμματική [Grammar](#)
Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)
Affiliation: [Sophist](#)

Aelius Dionysius was a Greek grammarian and lexicographer from Halicarnassus, active during the reign of the Roman emperor Hadrian in the 2nd century CE. His Roman family name indicates that he or his family held Roman citizenship, reflecting a degree of integration into the imperial system.

He worked during the period known as the Second Sophistic, a time of renewed interest in classical Greek language and culture. As a grammarian, he was part of the Atticist movement, which sought to define and preserve the classical Athenian Greek of the 5th and 4th centuries BCE as the standard for educated writing and speech.

His known work is a lexicon titled Attic Words. The book itself has not survived but is quoted extensively by later Byzantine scholars and compilers, through which modern knowledge of his work is preserved. According to scholars, his primary significance lies in his contribution to the Atticist tradition. His lexicon was a major source for later influential dictionaries, such as the Etymologicum Magnum and the lexicon of Hesychius of Alexandria, thereby helping to transmit knowledge of classical Greek vocabulary.

He is seen as part of the scholarly wing of the Second Sophistic, which aimed to regulate language use for the elite of the Roman Empire. The citations of his lost work remain crucial for understanding the linguistic debates of his era.

Works (1)

- Ἀττικά ὀνόματα · [Attic Names](#) · 600 passages

Other Sophist Authors

- Ἀχιλλεὺς ὁ Τατίος ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεὺς · [Achilles Tattius of Alexandria](#) · 1 work
- Κλαύδιος Αἰλιανός · [Aelian of Praeneste](#) · 4 works
- Πόπλιος Αἴλιος Ἀριστείδης Θεόδωρος · [Aelius Aristides of Smyrna](#) · 3 works
- Αἴλιος Θεών ὁ σοφιστής · [Aelius Theon the Sophist](#) · 1 work
- Ἀλκιδάμας ὁ Ἐλαεύς · [Alcidamas of Elaea](#) · 1 work
- Ἀλκίφρων ὁ Σοφιστής · [Alciphron the Sophist](#) · 1 work
- Ἀλέξανδρος ὁ τοῦ Νουμήνιου · [Alexander Son of Numenius](#) · 2 works
- Ἀλέξανδρος ὁ Ἐφέσιος · [Alexander the Ephesian Poet](#) · 1 work

- Ἀμφικράτης Ἀθηναῖος · Amphicrates Atheniensis · 1 work
- Ἀνώνυμος ὑπόμνημα εἰς Ἀφθόνιον · Anonymous Commentary on Aphthonius · 2 works
- Ἀντιφῶν ὁ Ἀθηναῖος · Antiphon of Athens · 9 works
- Ἀντιφῶν ὁ Ῥαμνούσιος · Antiphon of Rhamnus · 1 work